
PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT:

**AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP
ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER**



Project Title : Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders With Flow Designer.

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1. Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

2. User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

3. Project Objective

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

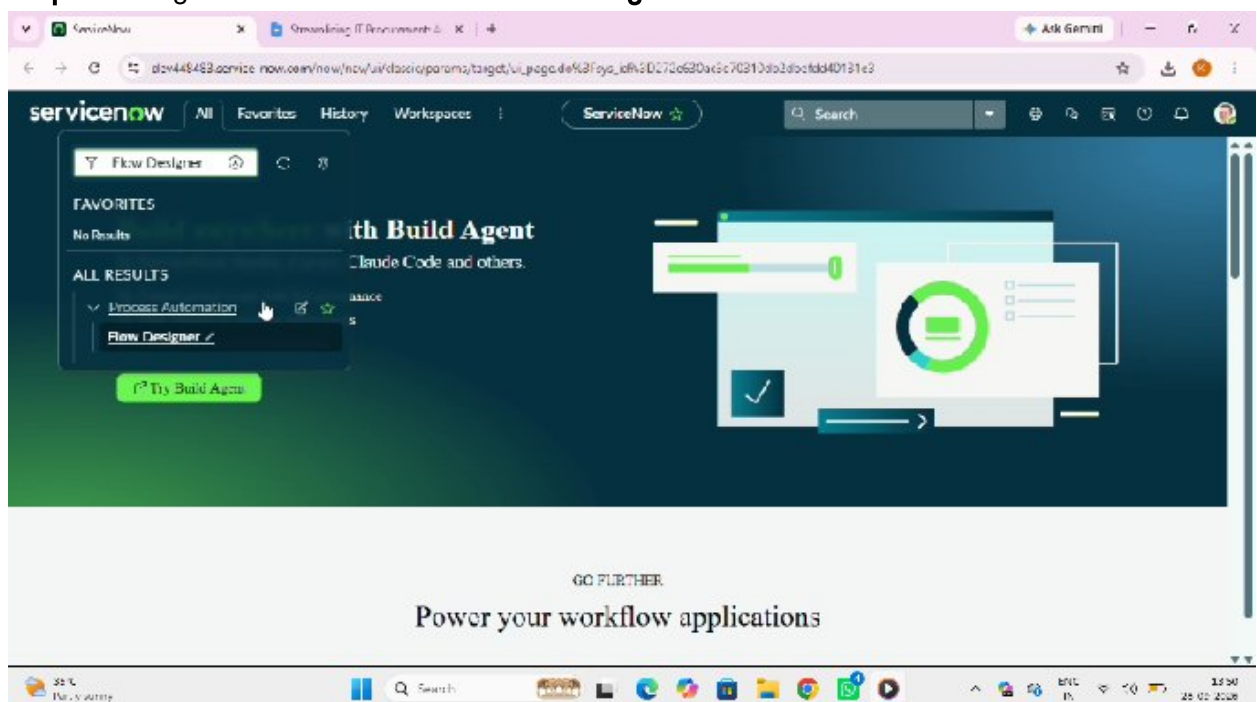
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

4. Step-by-Step Implementation Guide & Documentation

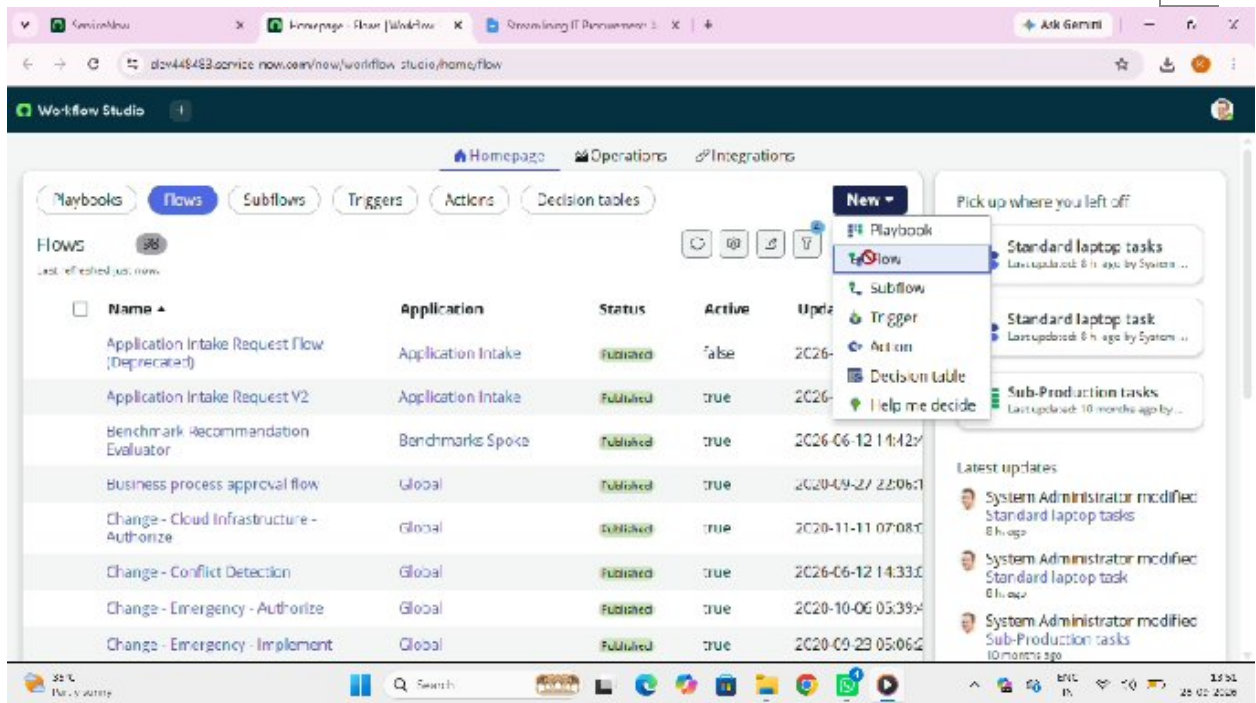
Milestone 1: Create Flow in Flow Designer

Activity 1: Create a Flow to generate a Catalog Task, update descriptions, and assign the task to the Hardware group upon Service Request approval.

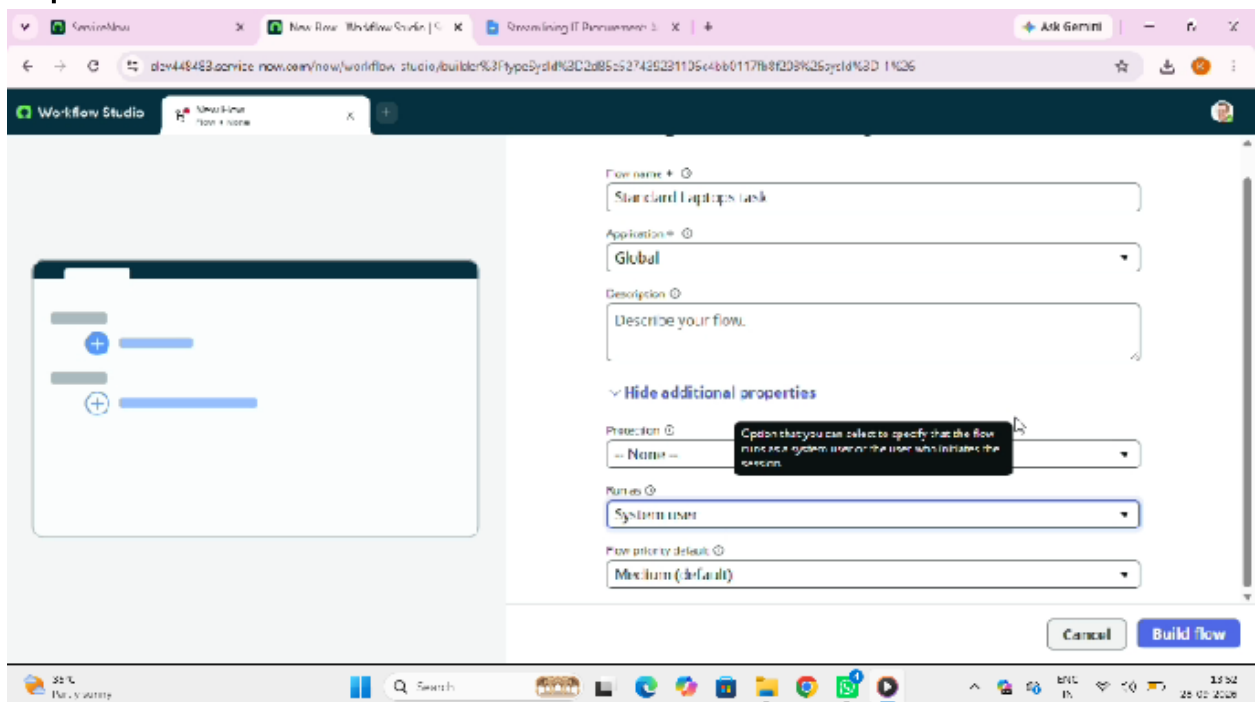
- **Step 1:** Log in to ServiceNow.
- **Step 2:** Navigate to **All** >> search for **Flow Designer**



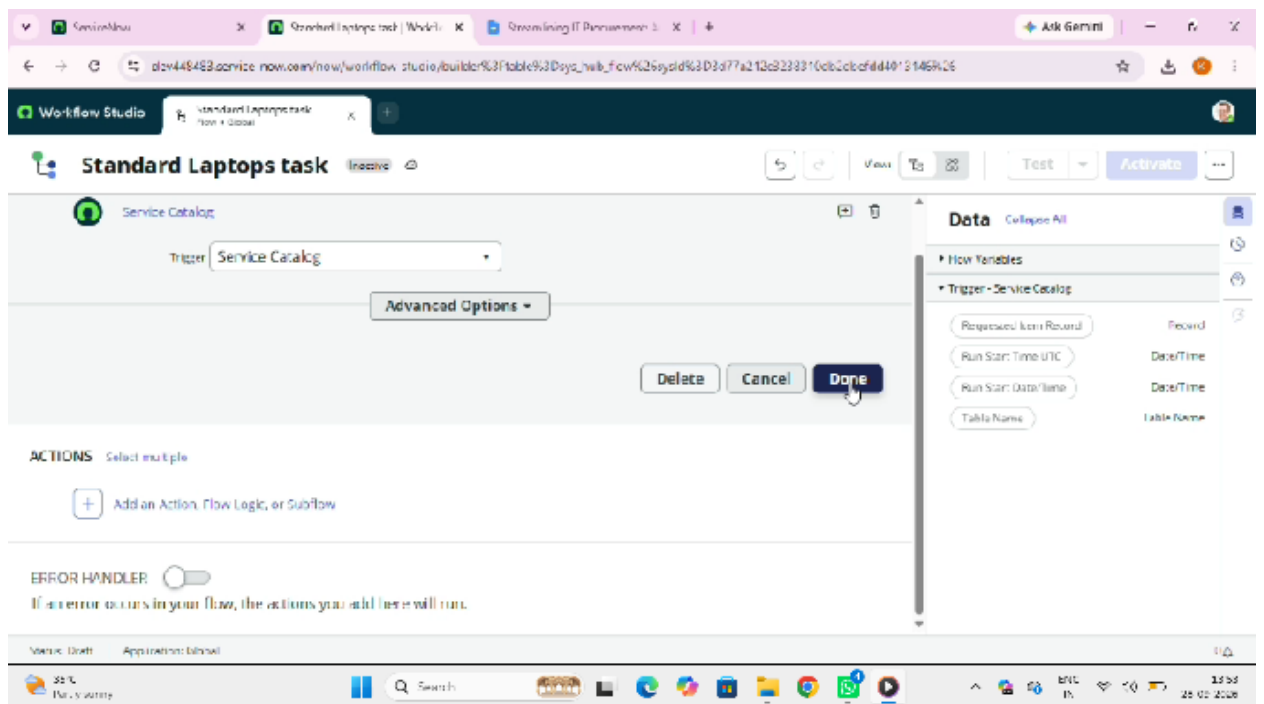
- **Step 3:** Click on **Flow Designer** under **Process Automation**.
- **Step 4:** Click on **New** and select **Flow**.



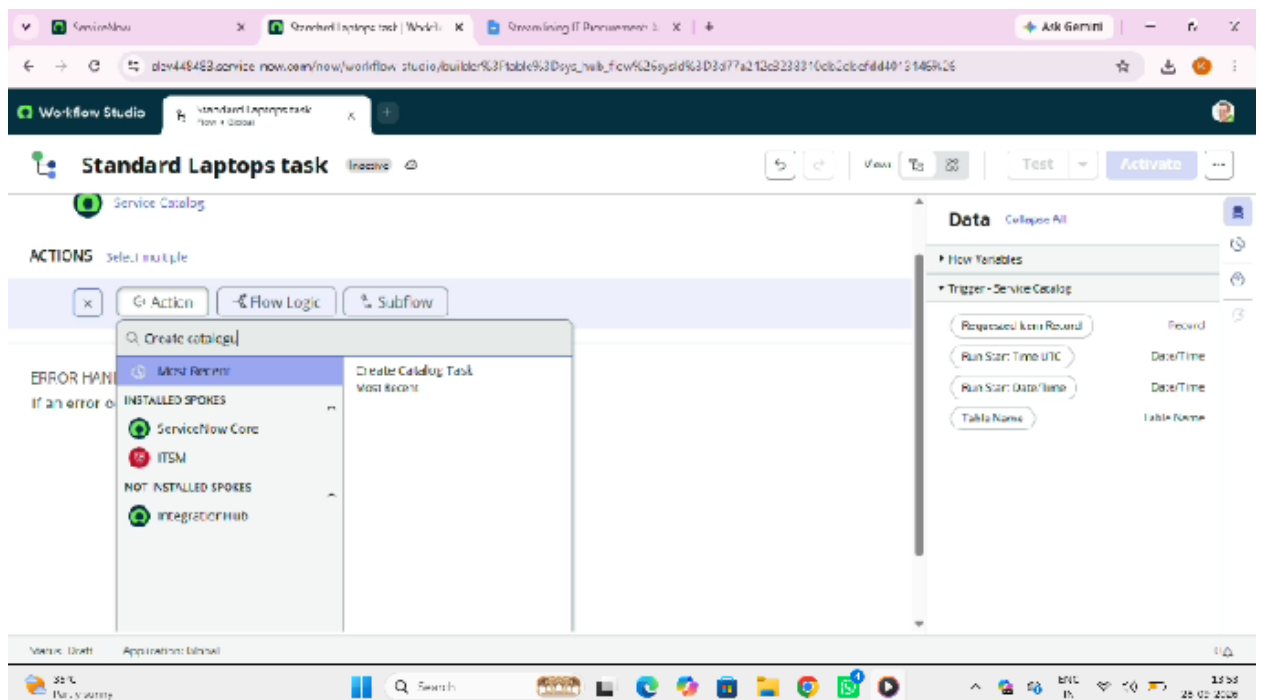
- **Step 5: Configure Flow Properties:**
 - **Flow Name:** Standard laptop task
 - **Application:** Global
 - **Run As:** System user
- **Step 6: Click Submit .**



- **Step 7:** Click on **Add a trigger** , search for **Service Catalog** , select it, and click **Done** .



- **Step 8:** Under **Actions** , click **Add an action** , search for **Create Catalog Task** , and select it.



- **Step 9:** Configure the Create Catalog Task action fields:
 - **Action:** Create Catalog Task

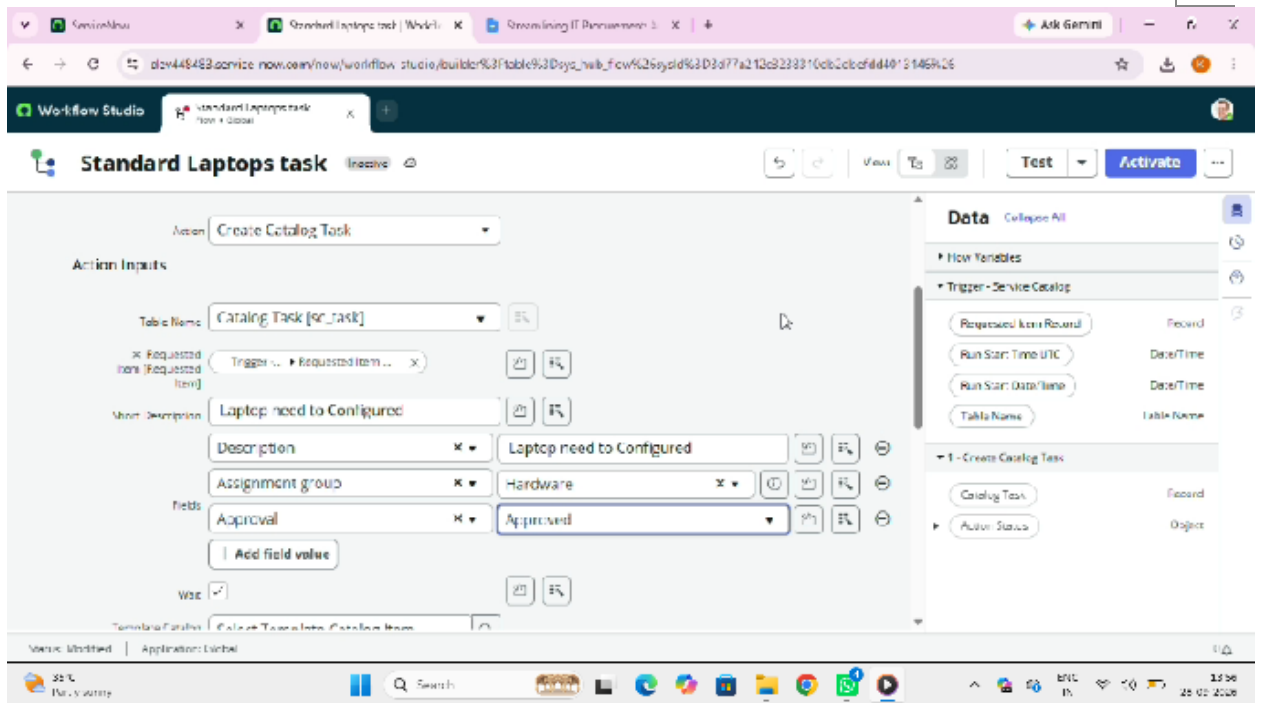
- **Request item:** Drag and drop the Requested Item Record.

The screenshot shows the 'Standard Laptops task' configuration in Oracle Workflow Studio. The 'Action Properties' section is active, showing the action 'Create Catalog Task'. The 'Action Inputs' section contains the following fields:

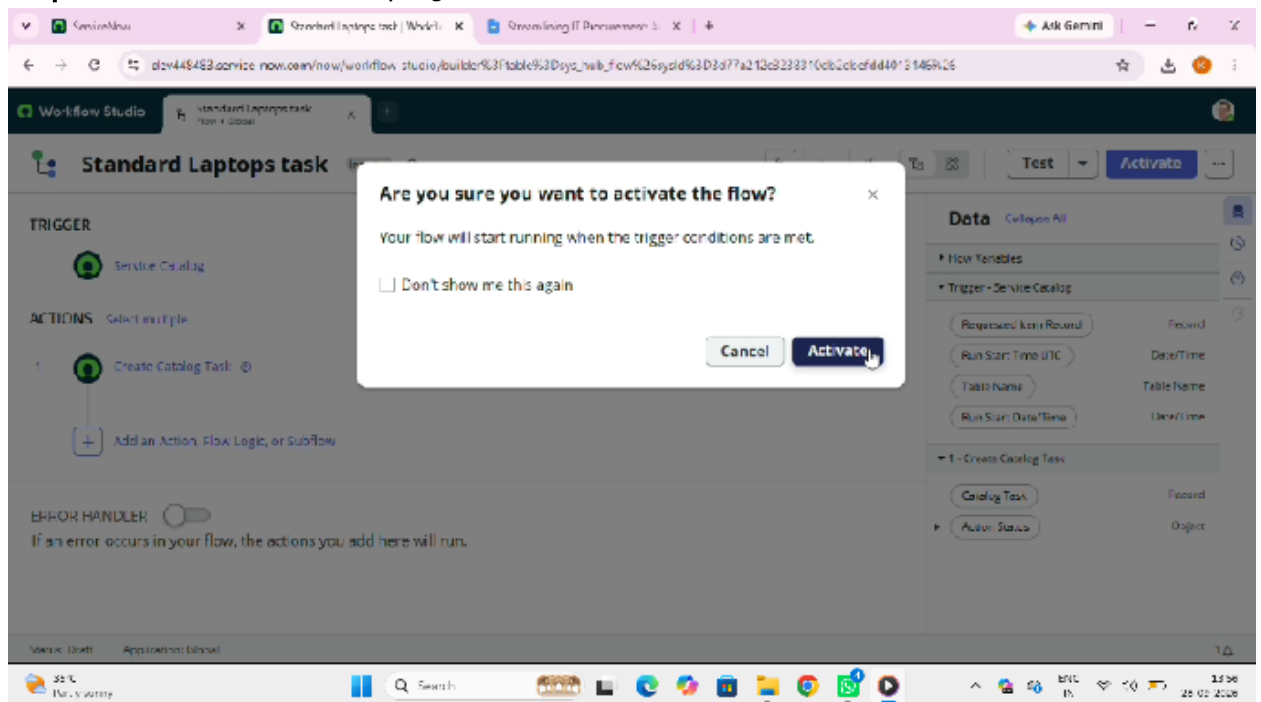
- Table Name:** Catalog Task (\$c_task)
- Requested Item:** Drag and drop Requested Item Record
- Short Description:** (Empty)
- Fields:** + Add field value
- Use:** ☒
- Template Catalog:** Select Template Catalog Item

The right sidebar shows the 'Data' panel with 'New Variables' and 'Trigger - Service Catalog' section. The 'Requested Item Record' variable is highlighted. Below this is the '1 - Create Catalog Task' section with 'Catalog Task' and 'Action: Status'.

- **Table:** Auto-populated as Catalog Task (\$c_task).
- **Short description:** Laptop need to Configured
- **Description:** Click **Add field value** , select **Description** , and enter **Laptop need to Configured**
- **Assignment group:** Select **Hardware** .
- **Approval:** Select **Approved** .
- Leave remaining fields as default and click **Done** .



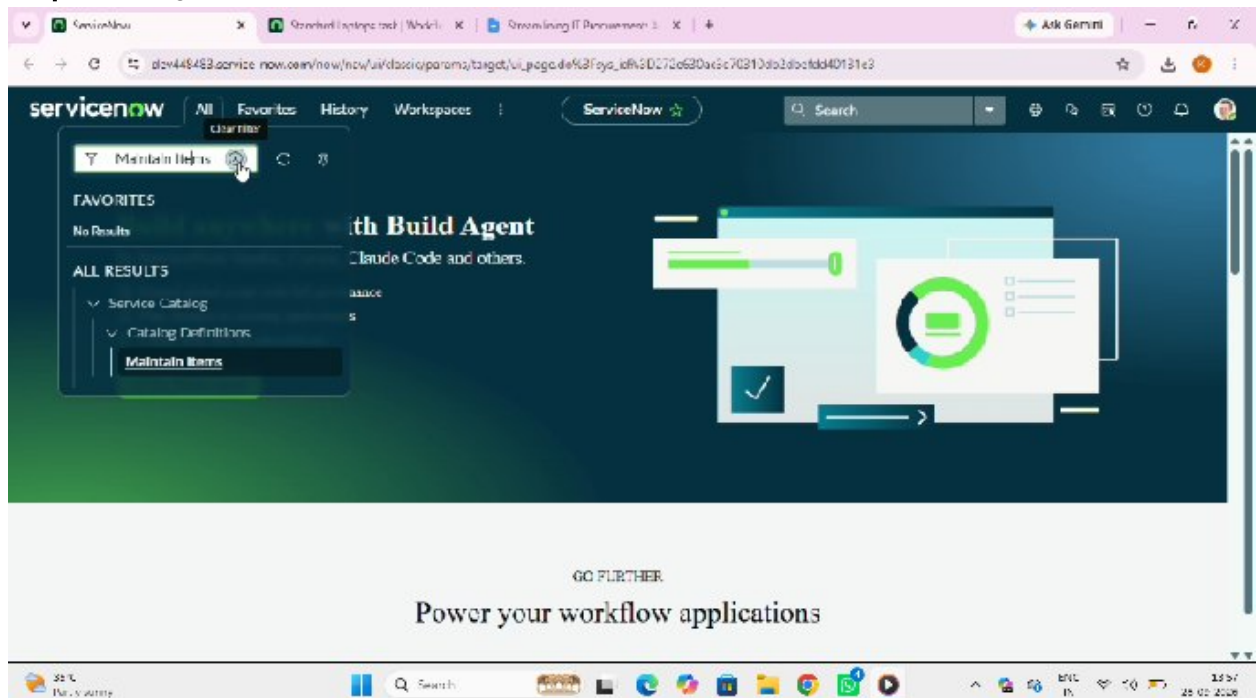
- **Step 10:** Click **Save** on the top right, then click **Activate** and confirm activation.



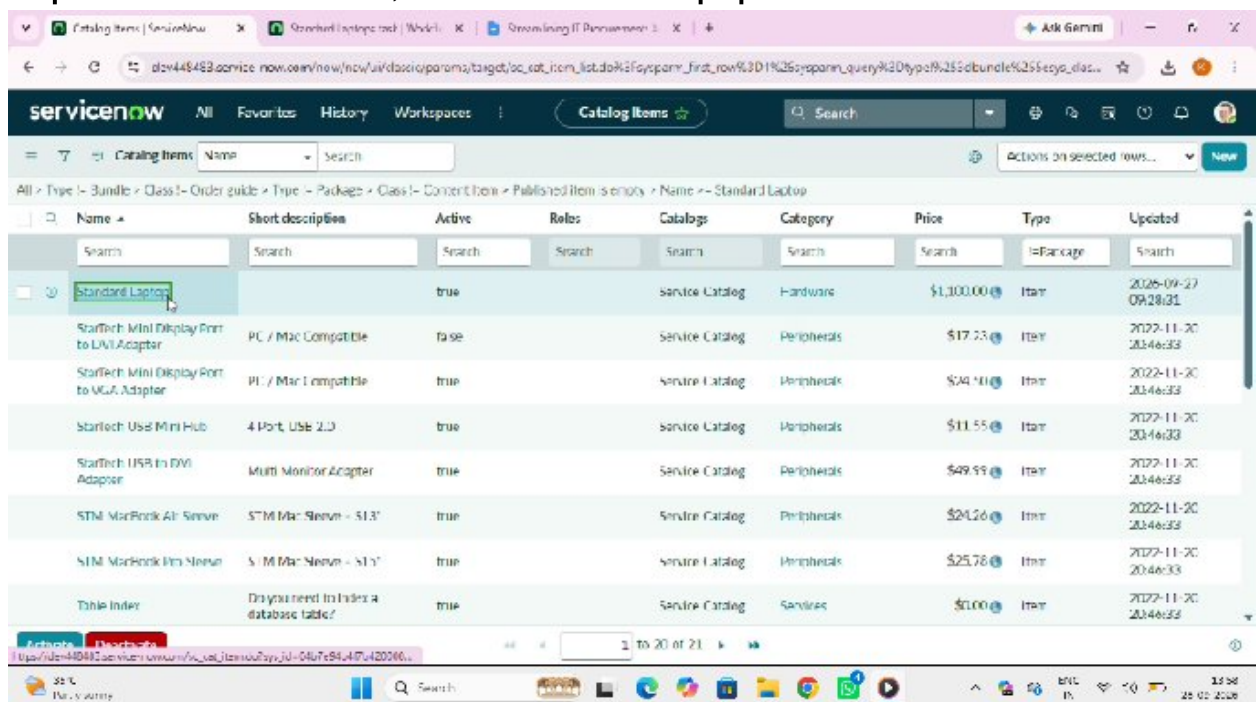
Milestone 2: Flow Assignment to Catalog Item

Activity 1: Link the newly created flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

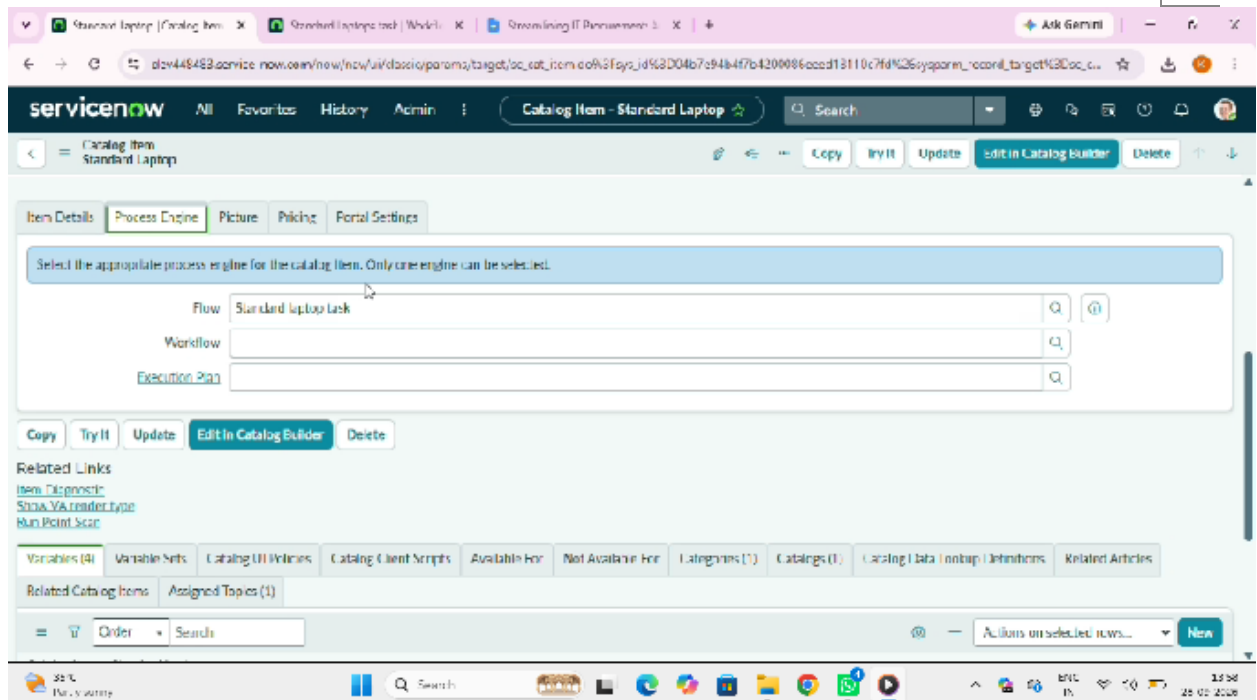
- **Step 1:** Open ServiceNow.
- **Step 2:** Navigate to **All** >> search for **Maintain Items** .



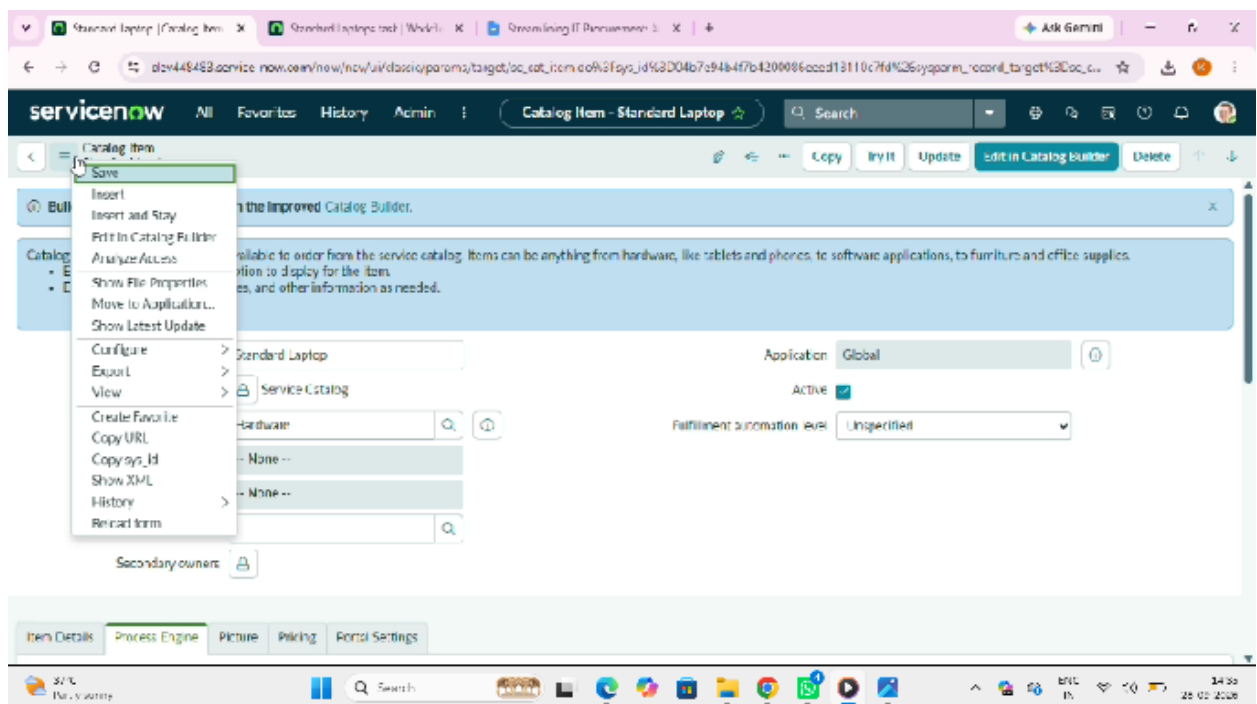
- **Step 3:** Select **Maintain Items** .
- **Step 4:** Under the Name field, search for **Standard Laptop** and select the record.



- **Step 5:** Go to the **Process Engine** tab/section.
- **Step 6:** Remove any existing workflows and select **Flow** .
- **Step 7:** Select the flow created earlier: **Standard Laptop Task** .



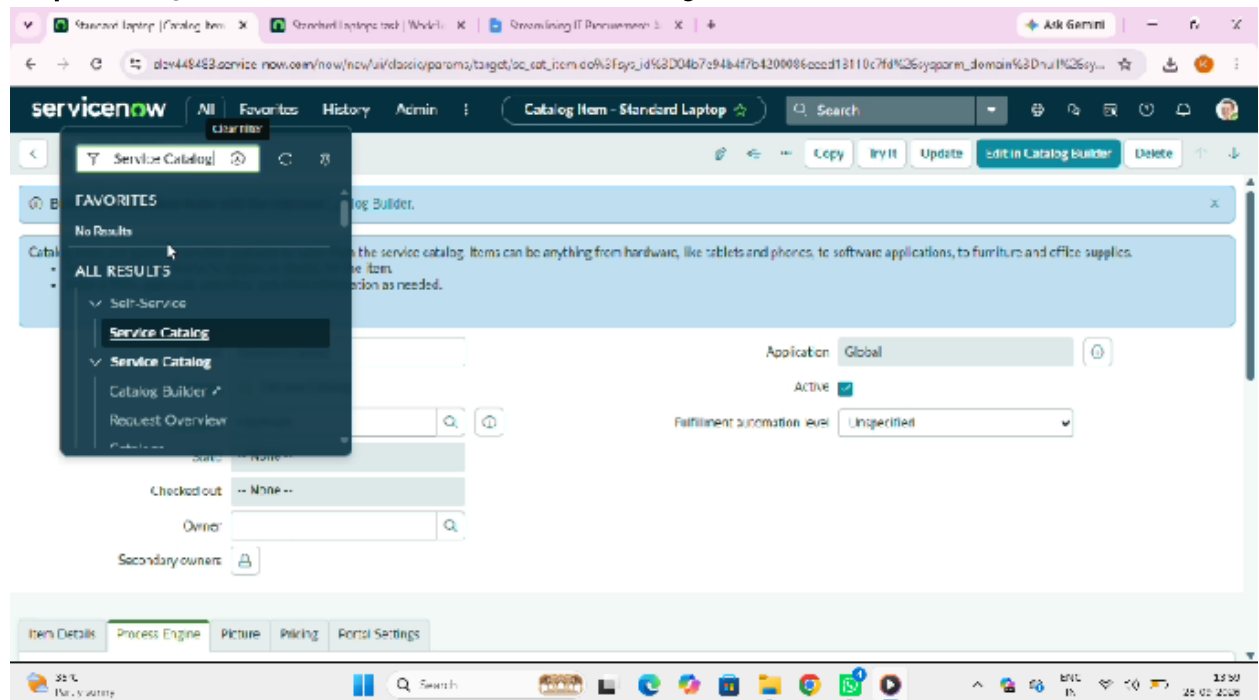
- **Step 8:** Click on the context menu (hamburger menu) or Save button to save the record.



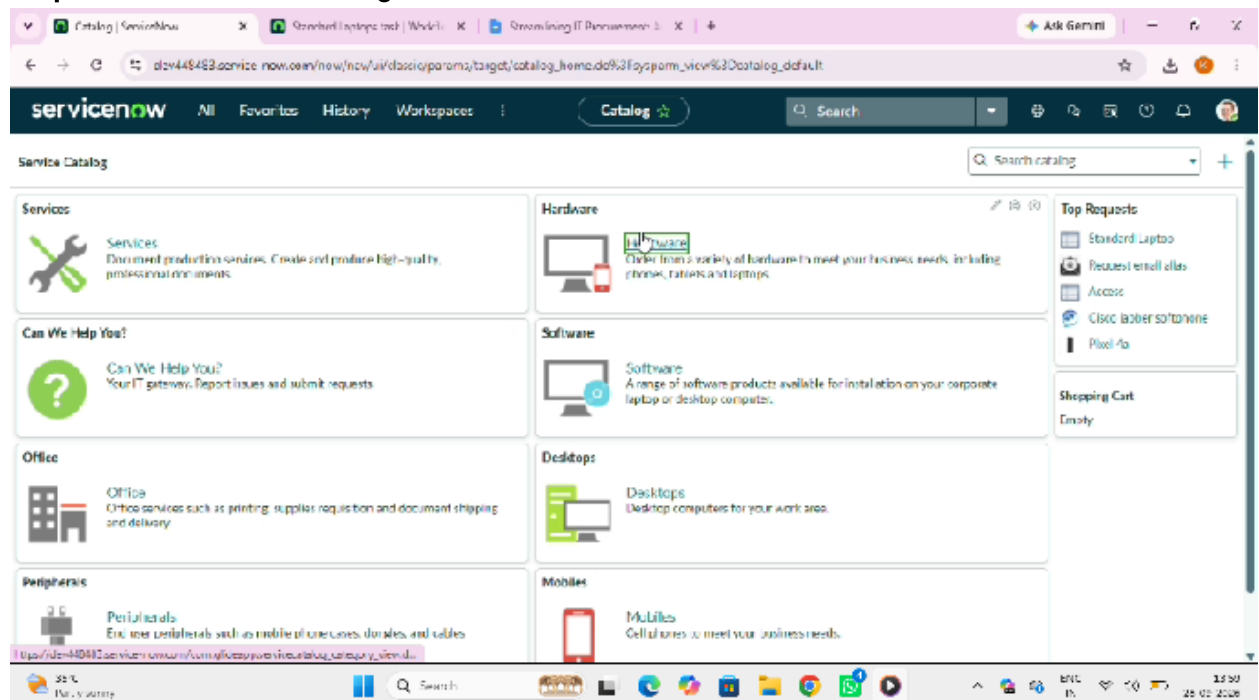
Milestone 3: End-to-End Testing & Service Catalog Validation

Activity 1: Place an order via the Service Catalog and verify approvals and generated tasks.

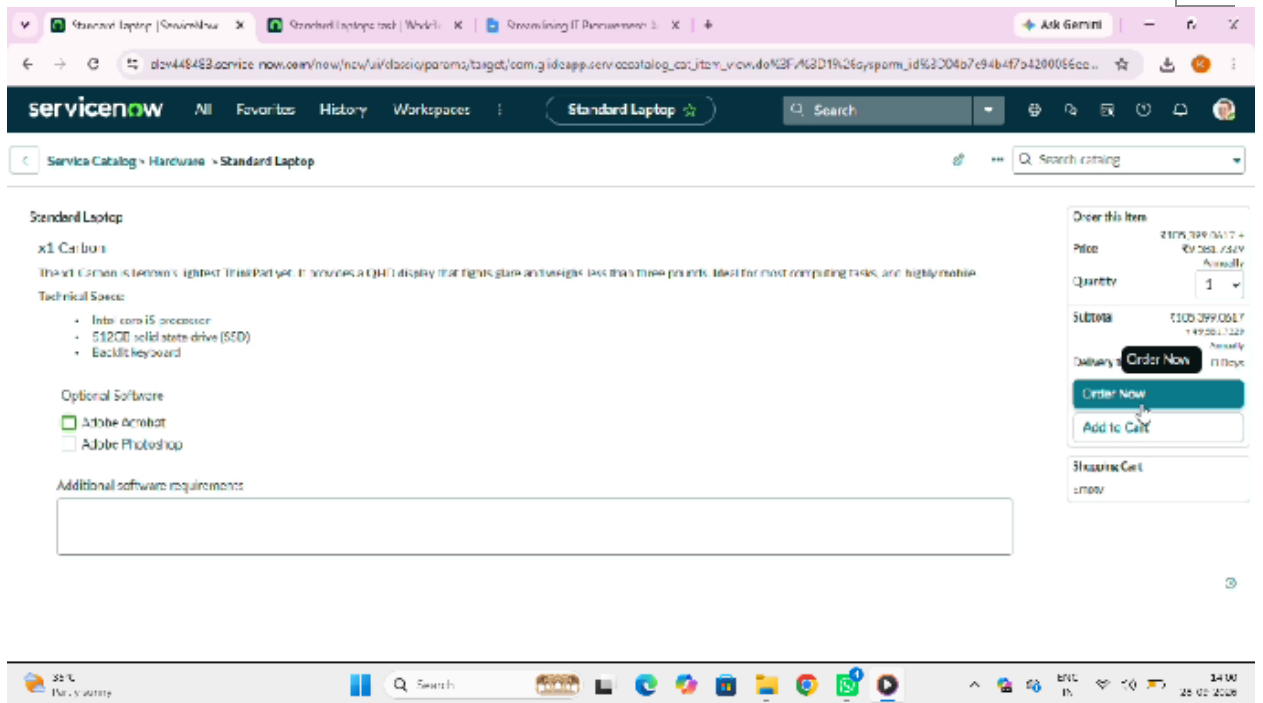
- **Step 1:** Navigate to **All** >> search for **Service Catalog** .



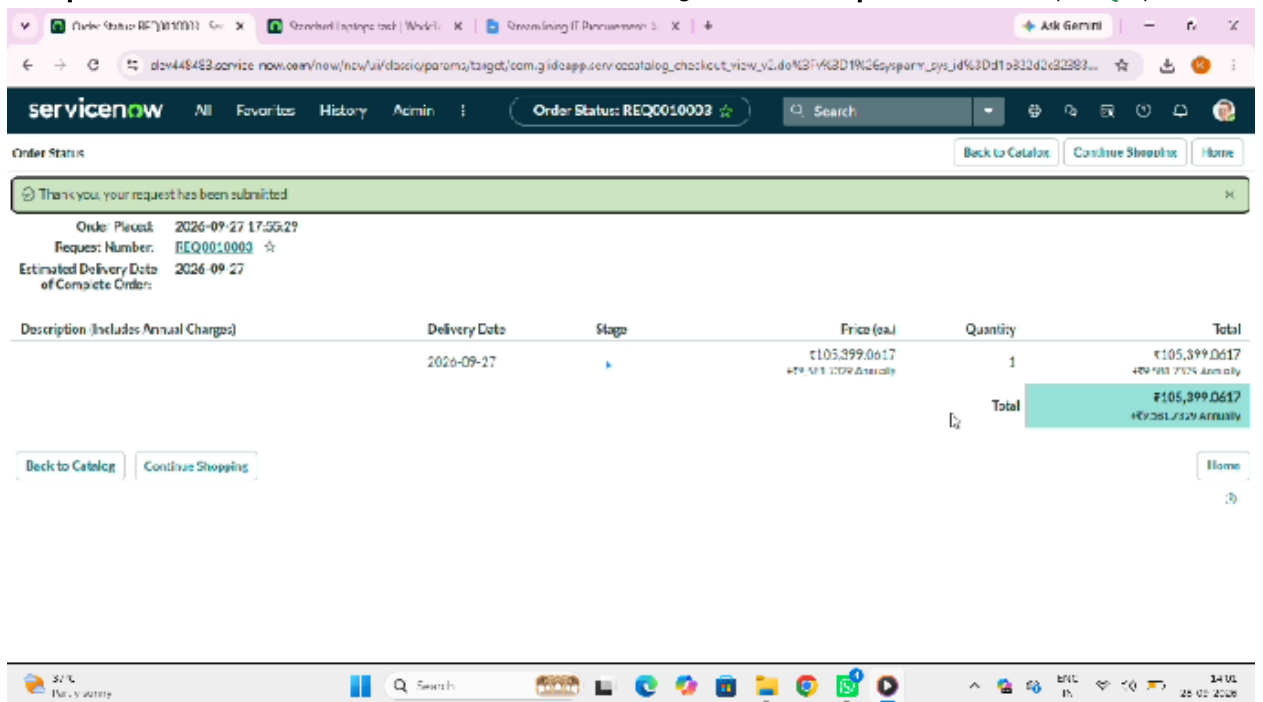
- **Step 2:** Click **Service Catalog** >> click **Hardware** .



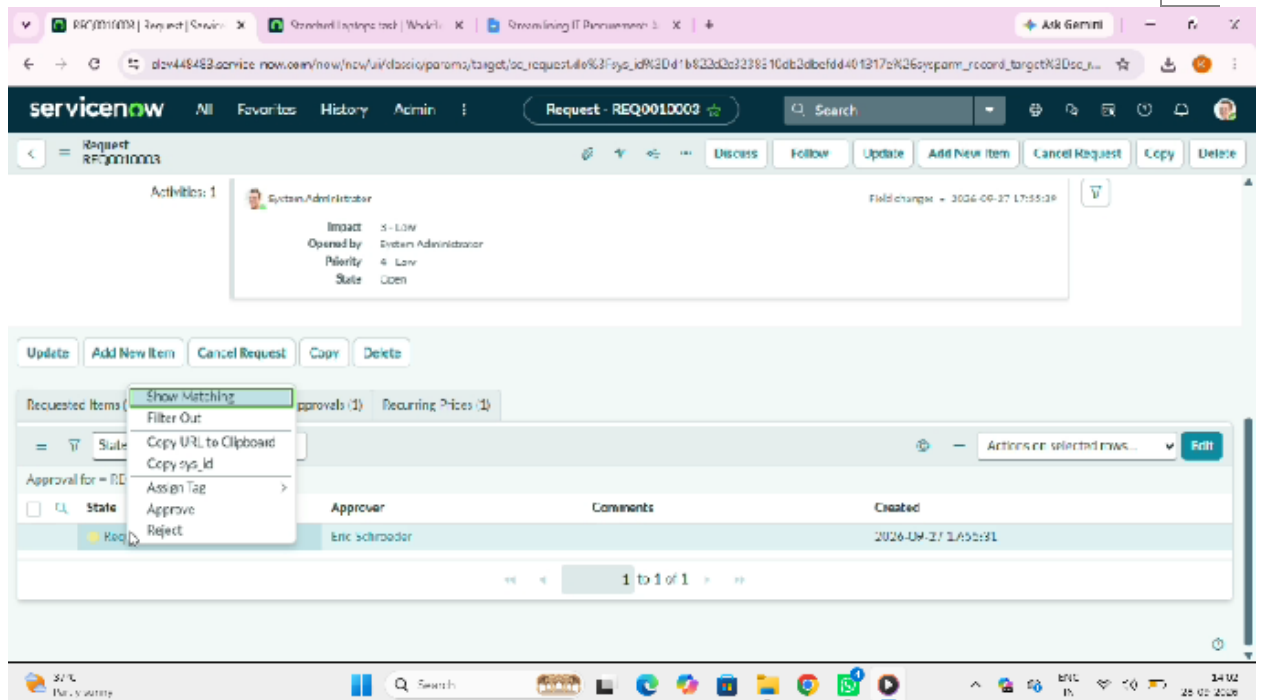
- **Step 3:** Locate and click on **Standard Laptop** .
- **Step 4:** Click **Order Now** to submit the request.



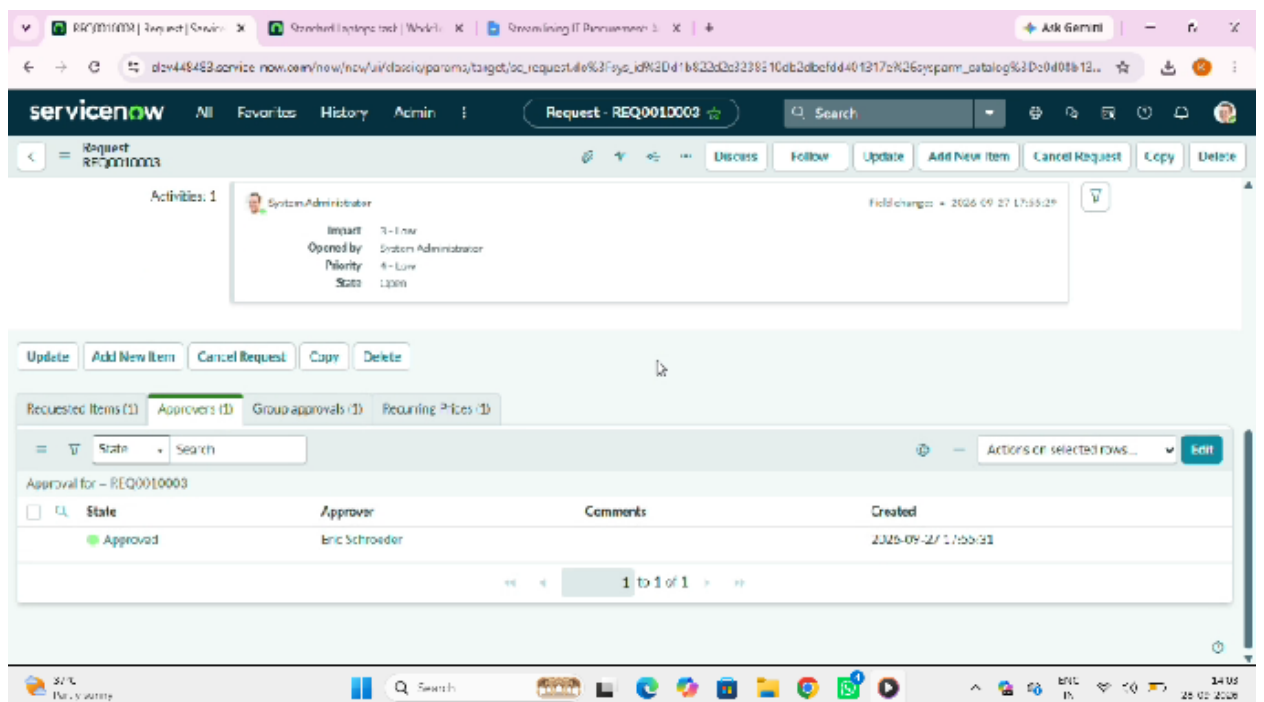
- **Step 5:** From the order status screen, click on the generated **Request Number** (REQ...).



- **Step 6:** Scroll down to the **Approvers** section.



- **Step 7:** Right-click the approval record, configure/view, and change state to **Approve**.



- **Step 8:** Navigate to the **Requested Items (RITM)** section and open the RITM record.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for a request titled "Request - REQ0010003". The page includes a header with the ServiceNow logo and navigation tabs. Below the header, there's a section for "Activities" showing a list of activities. The main content area displays a table of "Requested Items".

Number	Quantity	Catalog	Item	Due date	Price	Assigned to	Stage
REQ0010003	1	(empty)	Standard Laptop	2026-09-27 17:55:28	€120,395.0617	(empty)	

- **Step 9:** Scroll down to the **Catalog Tasks** related list/section and open the task record.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for a "Requested Item - RITM0010003". The page includes a header with the ServiceNow logo and navigation tabs. Below the header, there's a section for "Related Links" and a "Catalog Tasks" table.

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SC TASK0010003	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop need to Configure	2026-09-27 17:55:28	(empty)	

- **Step 10:** Verify that the task status, short description (**Laptop need to Configure**) and assigned group (**Hardware**) are correctly populated.

ServiceNow Catalog Task - SCTASK0010003

Number: SCTASK0010003

Assigned to: [Search]

Configuration item: [Search]

Active: ☒

Approval: Approved

Priority: -- None --

State: Open

Request item: RITM0010003

Requested for: System Administrator

Short description: Laptop need to Configured

Description: Laptop need to Configured

Work notes: Work notes

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes: 2020-09-27 17:33:39

5. Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

6. Demo Link :

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JE4BSQaxmTknBbU6lXir0fwZvhYc4nJJ/view?usp=drivesdk>